

HIPAA-Safe Google Review Reply Checklist

For med spas, aesthetic clinics, dental offices, and small medical practices.

Before you reply

- Wait at least a few hours. Defensive replies happen in the first hour.
- Read the review fully. Identify the actual complaint type.
- Check whether the reviewer named a treatment, provider, or visit date.
- If they did, take a screenshot. You will not reference the detail publicly, but you may need it for internal follow-up.

In the public reply, NEVER

- Confirm whether the reviewer was a patient.
- Name the treatment, procedure, or service they had.
- Reference their appointment date, time, or provider by name.
- Mention billing, insurance, or financial details.
- Offer a refund or discount in the public reply.
- Argue point by point with the reviewer's claims.
- Quote any specific HIPAA-protected detail to deny or correct it.

In the public reply, ALWAYS

- Open with one short line of thanks for the feedback.
- Acknowledge the feeling, not the fact. 'We are sorry your experience did not meet expectations.'
- State a privacy line. 'Because patient privacy matters, we cannot discuss specifics publicly.'
- Move the conversation private. 'Please contact us at [phone or email] so we can learn more.'
- Keep total length to 2 to 4 sentences.
- Have a second person read it before posting if the review is emotional or specific.

After posting

- Log the reply in your review tracker so it does not sit unanswered.
- If it qualifies for Google removal (fake, off-topic, from a non-patient), flag it through Google Business Profile.
- If the reviewer responds privately, handle service recovery in writing. Keep emails to factual, kind, and short.
- Do not re-engage publicly even if the reviewer escalates. The audience for the public thread is future patients, not the reviewer.